Organizational Behaviour - Solved Question Papers

MBA Semester I (2024 Pattern) | Paper 1: [6430]-502 | Paper 2: [6380]-5002

PAPER 1 : [6430]-502 | OB 502 MJ GC-20 Organizational Behaviour

Q1) Solve any five (2 marks each) - all eight solved

a) Define Organizational Behavior.

Organizational Behaviour (OB) is the systematic study of the actions and attitudes of **individuals, groups and structure** within an organisation, in order to apply this knowledge for improving the organisation's effectiveness. (Stephen Robbins)

b) List the models of OB.

- Autocratic model
- Custodial model
- Supportive model
- Collegial model (and System model)

c) List the types of groups.

- **Formal groups:** command group, task group (committee).
- **Informal groups:** interest group, friendship group.
- Also: primary and secondary groups, in-group and out-group, reference group.

d) Differentiate between managers and leaders.

Manager	Leader
Appointed by organisation; has formal authority	May emerge from the group; influence is based on trust and personality
Focuses on planning, organising, controlling (do things right)	Focuses on vision, inspiration and change (do the right things)
Follows rules and maintains stability	Challenges status quo and brings innovation
Short term, 'how and when'	Long term, 'what and why'

e) List the three steps in Kurt Lewin's model of change.

- **Unfreezing** - create awareness and readiness for change, reduce resistance.
- **Changing (Moving)** - introduce the new behaviour, systems or methods.
- **Refreezing** - stabilise the change and make it a permanent habit.

f) Identify two personality assessment models.

- **Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)** - 16 types based on four dichotomies (E/I, S/N, T/F, J/P).
- **Big Five model (OCEAN)** - openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness, neuroticism. (Other: 16PF, Johari Window)

g) Name the two content theories of motivation.

- Maslow's Need Hierarchy Theory
- Herzberg's Two-Factor (Motivation-Hygiene) Theory (also McClelland's need theory, Alderfer's ERG)

h) Define leadership. List the names of two leaders.

Leadership is the process of **influencing and inspiring a group of people to willingly work towards achievement of common goals**. Examples of leaders: Mahatma Gandhi, Ratan Tata (also N. R. Narayana Murthy, Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj).

Q2) Solve any two out of three (5 marks each) - all three solved

a) Explain how the five-stage model of group development can be applied in a team project setting.

Tuckman's model says every group goes through five stages. For an MBA team project:

- **Forming:** members meet, are polite but uncertain about goals, roles and leader. *In a team project:* students are allotted groups, introduce themselves, discuss topic and expectations. The leader should clarify the objective and timeline.
- **Storming:** conflict arises over roles, work division, leadership and ideas. *Example:* disagreement on who will do the PPT or data collection. The team should manage this by open discussion and clear role allocation.
- **Norming:** group cohesion develops; rules and norms are accepted. *Example:* fixing meeting times, deadlines and communication group; members start trusting each other.
- **Performing:** the group works efficiently towards the goal; roles are clear, problems are solved by the team. *Example:* research is done, report is written and presentation is practised smoothly.
- **Adjourning:** project is completed and the group dissolves. *Example:* final submission, feedback and celebration; members reflect on learning.

Application: if the project guide and team leader know these stages, they can expect conflict in storming as normal, not as failure, and take actions accordingly.

b) Compare the managerial grid theory of leadership with the path-goal theory of leadership.

Basis	Managerial Grid (Blake and Mouton)	Path-Goal Theory (Robert House)
Type	Behavioural theory	Contingency (situational) theory
Core idea	Leadership is a combination of two dimensions: concern for people and concern for production, each on a 1 to 9 scale	Leader clears the path to help followers achieve goals, by selecting a style fitting the situation
Styles	Impoverished (1,1), Authority-compliance (9,1), Country club (1,9), Middle of the road (5,5), Team management (9,9)	Directive, supportive, participative, achievement-oriented
Situation factors	Does not consider the situation; says (9,9) is the best style always	Considers follower characteristics (ability, locus of control) and environment (task structure, work group)
Focus	What the leader is concerned about	How the leader motivates through expectancy (path to rewards)
Use	Training and assessment of leaders	Selecting style according to subordinates' needs

c) Describe the types of organizational change and provide an example of each type.

- **Planned change:** deliberate and well-thought-out change for a goal. *Example:* an organisation implementing SAP/ERP software.
- **Unplanned (reactive) change:** forced by sudden external or internal events. *Example:* shifting to work-from-home due to COVID-19.
- **Incremental (first-order) change:** small continuous improvements. *Example:* kaizen on a manufacturing line, upgrading a process step.
- **Transformational (second-order, radical) change:** fundamental change of strategy, structure or culture. *Example:* Kodak or Nokia changing business model; Tata Motors moving to EV.
- **Strategic, structural, technological and people-oriented change:** new business strategy, restructuring departments, introduction of AI tools, training and attitude change.

Q3) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Apply the supportive model of OB to improve employee engagement in a midsized company.

Supportive model: Management's role is to support employees in doing their job rather than to command them. Basis is leadership, and the employee orientation is performance and participation. It assumes that employees are not passive; they want to work and are self-motivated if the work environment is supportive. It is built on Herzberg's higher-order needs and McGregor's Theory Y.

Steps to improve engagement (in a midsized company of, say, 400 employees)

1. **Supportive leadership training:** train managers to coach, listen and guide. *Why:* employees stay or leave because of their manager.
2. **Two-way communication:** regular town halls, open-door policy, one-to-one meetings and suggestion boxes. *Why:* employees feel heard and trusted.
3. **Participation in decisions:** involve employees in goal setting and problem solving, e.g. quality circles. *Why:* ownership increases commitment.
4. **Recognition and feedback:** instant appreciation, 'employee of the month', constructive feedback. *Why:* satisfies esteem needs.
5. **Growth and development:** training, mentoring, job rotation and career paths. *Why:* shows organisation cares about their future.
6. **Work-life balance and well-being:** flexible timings, wellness programmes, counselling. *Why:* reduces stress and burnout.
7. **Empowerment and resources:** give authority, tools and psychological safety to make decisions and to try new ideas without fear.
8. **Measure and improve:** conduct engagement surveys (Gallup Q12), pulse checks and act on the results.

Expected results: higher job satisfaction and morale, lower absenteeism and turnover, higher productivity.
Limitation: the model works well where employees are mature and self-driven; in a crisis, some direction is still required.

b) Using Vroom's Expectancy Theory, design a motivation plan for a sales team struggling to meet its targets.

Vroom's theory: Motivation (Force) = **Expectancy x Instrumentality x Valence**. If any one factor is zero, motivation is zero.

Component	Meaning	Question salesperson asks
Expectancy (E)	Effort leads to performance	'If I work harder, can I really reach the target?'
Instrumentality (I)	Performance leads to reward	'If I reach the target, will I surely get the reward?'
Valence (V)	Value of the reward	'Do I value this reward?'

Motivation plan (actions)

1. **Raise Expectancy (effort -> performance):** (a) set realistic, achievable and SMART targets (break the yearly target into monthly and weekly targets); (b) provide product knowledge and selling-skill training, CRM tools and lead support; (c) coach weak performers, assign appropriate territories and remove obstacles like delay in supply.
2. **Raise Instrumentality (performance -> reward):** (a) make a transparent incentive scheme: e.g. 2% commission up to target, 4% above target and a bonus for 110%; (b) pay incentives on time and avoid favouritism; (c) publish a leaderboard and review performance monthly to link results with rewards.
3. **Raise Valence (value of rewards):** (a) survey the team to know what they want: cash incentives, extra leave, promotion, foreign trip, recognition; (b) offer a choice of rewards (cafeteria style) and non-monetary recognition like awards and career growth.
4. **Monitoring and feedback:** weekly review meetings, quick feedback, adjust targets with market changes.
5. **Team spirit:** team-based incentives together with individual incentives to reduce unhealthy rivalry.

Result: When salespeople believe that effort will give performance (E high), performance will give reward (I high) and the reward is attractive (V high), their motivation and the sales results improve.

Q4) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Analyze how stereotyping and the halo effect can influence the selection process of a class representative in your class.

Perception is how we interpret information about others. Errors in perception influence selection of a class representative (CR).

Stereotyping

It is judging a person on the basis of the group he/she belongs to, not on personal merit. *Examples in CR selection:*

- 'Engineering students are good at leadership, arts students are not', so students from a technical background are chosen.
- 'Girls are shy / boys are bold'; 'Students from big cities speak well' or 'students from rural areas cannot manage'. So a capable rural student may be rejected because of his accent or language.
- Students from a certain region, caste or community vote for each other, ignoring ability.

Halo effect

It is forming an overall impression of a person on the basis of one single trait (good or bad). *Examples:*

- A student who is a topper in exams, handsome / smartly dressed or a fluent English speaker is assumed to be a good leader, even though his people skills are unknown.
- A popular student who is the best cricketer is voted since 'he is great at everything'.
- The reverse (horn effect): a student who once came late or failed a subject is thought to be incapable, even if he is very good at coordination.

Impact

- The wrong person may be selected (poor communication with faculty, weak handling of class problems).
- Talented but less-visible students are overlooked, which causes demotivation and unfairness; class cohesion falls.
- Selection becomes subjective, not merit-based.

Remedies

- Define clear selection criteria: communication, responsibility, availability, past record of teamwork.
- Take the candidate's manifesto / presentation, a structured question-and-answer, and secret ballot; consider peer opinion from many people.
- Be aware of one's own biases; evaluate on multiple traits and not one trait.

b) Analyze the impact of organizational change on employee stress levels and recommend strategies to manage this stress.

Organisational change (restructuring, merger, new technology, change in leadership) creates uncertainty, so employees experience stress.

Impact of change on stress

- **Job insecurity:** fear of layoffs, transfer, demotion or loss of status.
- **Uncertainty and loss of control:** not knowing what will happen next.
- **Increased workload:** learning new systems while continuing old work, longer hours.
- **Role ambiguity and conflict:** duties and reporting lines become unclear.
- **Loss of relationships:** broken teams, new bosses and culture clash.
- **Effects:** physical (headache, fatigue, high blood pressure), psychological (anxiety, burnout, low morale) and behavioural (absenteeism, resistance, errors, turnover).

Strategies to manage stress during change

1. **Clear and early communication:** explain why the change is needed, what will change and the timeline; use town halls and FAQs.
2. **Employee participation:** involve employees in planning and take their suggestions, so they feel control.
3. **Training and support:** training for new skills, mentors and a help desk.
4. **Counselling and wellness programmes:** Employee Assistance Programme (EAP), yoga and meditation, time management workshops.
5. **Supportive leadership:** managers should show empathy, be visible and available, and give recognition for adaptation.
6. **Realistic workload and phased implementation:** avoid too much change at once; give time to adjust.
7. **Job security assurances:** be honest about the impact; provide redeployment, outplacement or severance if layoffs.
8. **Feedback and follow-up:** pulse surveys and acting on concerns; celebrate small wins (Kotter's model).

Conclusion: change cannot be avoided, but stress can be reduced if management handles it with transparency, participation and support.

Q5) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Evaluate how the Johari Window can enhance self-awareness and team dynamics for MBA-I students in a group project.

The **Johari Window** (Joseph Luft and Harry Ingham, 1955) is a tool for understanding self-awareness and interpersonal relationships. It has four quadrants based on what is known / not known to self and to others.

	Known to self	Not known to self
Known to others	**1. Open (Arena):** known to me and to others	**2. Blind spot:** others know but I do not
Not known to others	**3. Hidden (Façade):** I know but others do not	**4. Unknown:** neither I nor others know

Application in an MBA-I group project (examples)

- **Open area:** Riya knows she is good at Excel and the team also knows it, so she gets the data analysis work. *Aim:* increase this area, since trust and efficiency increase.
- **Blind spot:** Amit thinks he is a good leader, but teammates feel he interrupts and does not listen. Through peer feedback after a meeting, he becomes aware and improves. This reduces conflict.
- **Hidden area:** Sneha is good at design but never tells anyone, as she is shy. By self-disclosure ('I can make the PPT'), the team uses her talent, and her contribution increases.
- **Unknown area:** a student who has never presented may find during the project that he is a good presenter; new situations (project, role play) reveal hidden potential.

How it improves self-awareness and team dynamics

- Self-disclosure shrinks the hidden area and feedback reduces the blind spot, so the open area grows.
- Better communication, trust and fewer misunderstandings; roles are matched with strengths.
- Team members learn to give and accept constructive feedback; conflicts are solved early; team cohesion and performance improve.

Evaluation

Strengths: simple, no cost, builds trust and self-insight. **Limitations:** depends on honesty and a safe climate; cultural hesitation to give feedback; not a scientific measurement. Overall, it is useful if used with respect and confidentiality.

b) Evaluate how Maslow's Need Hierarchy can be applied to understand and motivate an MBA-I student dealing with academic and personal challenges.

Maslow (1943) says human needs are arranged in five levels. A lower need must be reasonably satisfied before a higher need becomes a motivator. For an MBA-I student:

Level	Need	Challenge / example for MBA-I student	How to motivate
1	Physiological	Lack of sleep, poor hostel food, skipping meals during exams, long travel	Healthy mess food, proper sleep schedule, breaks and exercise
2	Safety	Fear of failing or backlog, education loan burden, uncertainty about placement, safe accommodation and financial security	Scholarships, part-time work, clear exam guidelines, career counselling, financial planning guidance
3	Love / Belonging (social)	Homesickness, loneliness in a new city, difficulty in making friends, group conflicts	Orientation and buddy programmes, clubs, teamwork, mentoring, family contact
4	Esteem	Wants recognition, good grades, respect of peers and faculty; feels inferior in front of classmates with better English or work experience	Praise, awards, leadership roles (CR, committee head), presentations, constructive feedback
5	Self-actualisation	Wants to achieve potential, become an entrepreneur or a great manager; to learn and grow	Live projects, internships, case competitions, research, entrepreneurship cell

Evaluation: It gives a simple, useful framework for teachers and mentors to identify which need is unsatisfied before motivating. **Criticism:** the order is not rigid (a student can chase grades although he is lonely), and it is based on Western culture; needs may overlap. So, it should be used flexibly with individual counselling.

PAPER 2 : [6380]-5002 | 102-GC-02 Organizational Behaviour

Q1) Solve any five (2 marks each) - all eight solved

a) Mention the nature of OB.

- It is an **interdisciplinary** field (psychology, sociology, anthropology).
- It is both a **science and an art**; a human-centred, goal-oriented, applied field.
- It uses a **contingency approach** (no one best way), and is a continuous learning area at individual, group and organisation levels.

b) What is the concept of Group Behaviour?

Group behaviour is the way members of a group **interact, influence one another and act together** to achieve common goals. It is affected by group norms, roles, cohesiveness, size and leadership; the group's behaviour is different from the sum of the individuals' behaviours.

c) Define Attitudes.

An attitude is a **learned tendency to feel, think and behave in a favourable or unfavourable way** towards people, objects or situations. It has three components: cognitive (belief), affective (feeling) and behavioural (action). Example: a positive attitude towards one's job.

d) What is meant by Halo effect?

Halo effect is a perception error in which an **overall impression of a person is formed on the basis of a single trait**, e.g. judging an employee as excellent in all areas just because he is very punctual or good looking.

e) What is Organizational Culture?

Organisational culture is the **system of shared values, beliefs, norms and practices** which members of an organisation hold, and which distinguishes it from other organisations. It guides how people behave ('the way we do things here'). Example: the innovation culture of Google or the ethical culture of Tata Group.

f) What is work-life balance?

Work-life balance is the **proper balance between professional work and personal life** (family, health, leisure), so that neither affects the other negatively. Flexible hours, work from home and leave policies help to maintain it. It reduces stress and improves productivity.

g) Write any two names of leadership styles.

- Autocratic leadership
- Democratic (participative) leadership (others: laissez-faire, transformational, transactional)

h) What is meant by Conflict?

Conflict is a **disagreement or clash between two or more parties (individuals or groups) due to incompatible goals, values, interests or perceptions**. It can be functional (healthy, improves ideas) or dysfunctional (harms performance).

Q2) Solve any two out of three (5 marks each) - all three solved

a) Discuss the various models of OB.

OB models explain the philosophy and assumptions through which management views its employees. Davis and Newstrom describe four main models (a fifth, the collegial, is sometimes added).

Model	Basis of model / managerial orientation	Employee orientation and result
Autocratic	Power; authority (boss decides)	Obedience; dependence on boss; minimum performance
Custodial	Economic resources; money and benefits (security)	Security and benefits; dependence on organisation; passive co-operation
Supportive	Leadership; support and help of manager	Job performance and participation; arousal of motivation; employee feels involved

Model	Basis of model / managerial orientation	Employee orientation and result
Collegial	Partnership; teamwork	Responsible behaviour, self-discipline; enthusiasm
System model	Trust, community and meaning (new model)	Passion and commitment; high psychological ownership

The supportive and collegial models suit modern knowledge organisations; the autocratic model suits crisis situations.

b) Describe the Equity Theory of Work Motivation.

Equity theory was given by **J. Stacy Adams (1963)**. It states that employees compare their **input-outcome ratio** with that of others (referent) and are motivated according to the fairness of this comparison.

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Own outcomes / Own inputs compared with Others' outcomes / Others' inputs
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- **Inputs:** effort, experience, education, skills, time. **Outcomes:** salary, promotion, recognition, benefits.
- **Equity (ratios equal):** the employee is satisfied and motivated.
- **Under-rewarded (own ratio lower):** feels anger and guilt of unfair treatment, so reduces effort, asks for a raise, distorts inputs, or leaves.
- **Over-rewarded (own ratio higher):** may feel guilt and increase effort or rationalise it.

Example: Two employees do the same work, but one gets Rs. 10,000 more; the other feels inequity and works less. **Implication:** managers should ensure fair pay, transparent promotion and appraisal systems.

c) Explain the five-stage model of group development.

Bruce Tuckman's model (1965) describes five stages through which groups develop:

- **Forming:** members get to know each other; there is uncertainty about purpose and leadership; polite behaviour.
- **Storming:** conflict about roles, power and methods; resistance to the leader.
- **Norming:** relationships become close, cohesion grows, rules and norms are accepted.
- **Performing:** the group is fully functional and focused on task accomplishment; high productivity.
- **Adjourning:** task is finished and the group disbands; members feel pride or sadness.

Example: a college project team passes through all these stages from group formation to final submission. (Some groups may go back from performing to storming when membership changes.)

Q3) Answer any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) What are the reasons for resistance to change? What can management do to overcome such resistance?

Reasons for resistance

Individual resistance	Organisational resistance
Fear of the unknown and uncertainty	Structural inertia (existing systems resist change)
Job and economic insecurity (layoff, pay cut)	Limited focus of change (one department changes but the others don't)
Habit and comfort with routine	Group inertia and strong norms
Selective perception (see only what supports their view)	Threat to existing power and resource allocation
Loss of status, power or social relationships	Sunk investments in old technology and past contracts
Lack of trust in management; poor communication	Poor timing and bad implementation by management

Ways to overcome resistance (Kotter and Schlesinger)

1. **Education and communication:** explain the need, benefits and plan for change.
2. **Participation and involvement:** involve those affected in planning the change so they own it.
3. **Facilitation and support:** training, counselling, time for adjustment.
4. **Negotiation and agreement:** give incentives or compensation to people who lose, e.g. early retirement packages.

5. **Manipulation and co-optation:** selective sharing of information, giving key resisters a role in the change (use carefully).
6. **Explicit and implicit coercion:** threats of transfer or dismissal as a last resort when speed is needed.
7. **Strong leadership, creating a vision, short-term wins** and following Lewin's unfreeze-change-refreeze approach.

b) Define Team. Explain the importance of team work in an organization.

Team: A team is a small number of people with complementary skills who are committed to a common purpose, performance goals and approach, and who hold themselves mutually accountable (Katzenbach and Smith). Example: a project team, a surgical team, a cricket team.

Importance of teamwork

- **Higher productivity and synergy:** the output of the team is more than the sum of individual outputs.
- **Better decisions and creativity:** diverse skills and many ideas.
- **Skill sharing and learning:** members learn from each other; flexibility in tasks.
- **Motivation and job satisfaction:** sense of belonging, support and recognition.
- **Reduces workload and stress** by sharing; faster completion of complex tasks.
- **Better employee relations and morale;** improves communication and coordination across departments.
- **Quality improvement and adaptability:** quick response to change and problems; reduces supervision cost.

Q4) Answer any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Describe the types of motivational patterns used to motivate employees in Indian organizations.

Indian organisations use different motivators based on the Indian culture, which is collectivist and relationship-oriented. Motivation patterns:

- **Financial incentives:** salary, bonus (Diwali bonus), ESOPs, performance-linked pay, gratuity and provident fund. Money is a key motivator in a country with income pressure.
- **Job security:** permanent job, particularly in government/PSU; Indian employees give high value to security (Maslow's safety need).
- **Non-financial recognition:** awards, appreciation letters, status and designation (Indians are status-conscious), titles.
- **Family and social orientation:** employee welfare - housing, medical, education for children, festival celebrations; employees feel the company is a 'family' (e.g. Tata, Infosys welfare practices).
- **Paternalistic leadership and relationship:** loyalty to a caring boss; respect for seniors and personal relationships.
- **Job enrichment and growth opportunities:** training, promotion, challenging work, particularly for the young and educated.
- **Participation and empowerment:** quality circles, suggestion schemes, as in Maruti Suzuki.
- **Spiritual / value-based motivators:** 'Nishkama karma' from the Gita - doing duty without attachment to the result; work as worship; sense of pride and purpose, e.g. nation-building.
- **Work-life balance and flexibility:** leaves for festivals, flexible work in IT companies.

Conclusion: effective Indian managers combine economic, social, status and value-based motivation as per the employee's need.

b) What is Organizational Change? State its nature and importance in the recent era with examples.

Meaning: Organisational change is a planned or unplanned alteration in an organisation's strategy, structure, technology, processes, people or culture in order to adapt to its environment and to improve its performance.

Nature

- Continuous and inevitable - environment keeps changing.
- Can be planned or unplanned, incremental or radical (transformational).
- Affects people, structure, technology and culture together (systemic).
- Faces resistance and requires leadership; involves a process (unfreeze-change-refreeze).
- Is both proactive (to take advantage of opportunities) and reactive (to respond to threats).

Importance in the recent era (with examples)

- **Technology:** digitalisation and AI force companies to change processes, e.g. banks moving to UPI and mobile banking; Reliance Retail going omnichannel.
- **Globalisation and competition:** Indian firms must change to compete globally, e.g. Tata acquiring JLR.
- **Survival and growth:** Kodak and Nokia failed to change; Netflix changed from DVD to streaming and survived.
- **Changing workforce and workplace:** Millennials/Gen Z, remote and hybrid work after COVID-19.
- **Customer expectations, sustainability and regulation:** shift to EVs, ESG norms, GST and data protection laws.
- **Innovation and efficiency:** improves productivity, cost control and employee skills.

Q5) Answer any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) A minimum level of conflict is good for an organization - Illustrate.

Meaning: Conflict is a disagreement between parties. The traditional view treats all conflict as bad. But the **interactionist view** (Robbins) says that a minimum level of conflict is necessary to keep the group viable, self-critical and creative. Conflict is of two types: **functional (constructive)** and **dysfunctional (destructive)**.

How a minimum level of conflict is beneficial

- **Stimulates creativity and innovation:** different ideas clash and new solutions emerge, e.g. disagreement between R&D and marketing creates a better product.
- **Better decision making:** assumptions are challenged and alternatives are evaluated; avoids 'groupthink'.
- **Prevents stagnation:** brings problems to the surface early and promotes change and improvement.
- **Increases motivation and healthy competition:** between teams, sales regions, etc.
- **Builds group cohesion and understanding:** after open discussion and resolution, relationships and trust increase.
- **Releases tension and encourages self-evaluation:** people express their feelings and the issue is solved instead of building up silently.

Level of conflict and performance

Level of conflict	Effect on performance
Too low (no conflict)	Complacency, stagnation, poor ideas, 'yes-men' culture; performance is low
Optimum (moderate)	Innovation, critical thinking, alert group; performance is high (functional conflict)
Too high	Chaos, hostility, stress, politics; performance is low (dysfunctional conflict)

Conclusion: the aim of management is not to eliminate conflict but to keep it at an optimum level and to resolve it constructively (collaboration, compromise, negotiation).

b) 'A leader is developed and not born.' Do you agree? Explain with reasons.

Two views: the **Trait (Great Man) theory** says leaders are born with qualities like intelligence, charisma and height. The **behavioural and contingency theories** say leadership can be learned and developed through training and experience.

I agree that a leader is developed and not only born, for the following reasons:

- **Leadership is a set of skills** (communication, decision making, motivating, vision) that can be learned through training, education and practice.
- **Experience and situations shape leaders:** Mahatma Gandhi became a leader after his experiences in South Africa; he was not a strong leader as a young barrister.
- **Behavioural theories** (Ohio State, Managerial Grid) show that effective behaviour, not birth traits, makes a leader; so a person can be trained in these behaviours.
- **Situational/contingency theories** (Fiedler, Hersey-Blanchard, Path-Goal) say a leader's success depends on the situation and can be improved by adapting style - which is learned.
- **Organisations invest in leadership development:** management trainee programmes, coaching, mentoring, MBA programmes, e.g. Tata Administrative Services, GE Crotonville.
- **Self-development:** self-awareness, emotional intelligence, and continuous learning improve leadership qualities.

Counter-view

Some inborn traits like intelligence, energy and charisma help (e.g. natural leaders, Shivaji Maharaj's courage). So, **leaders are both born and made, but development matters more.** Birth gives potential; training and experience convert it into leadership.